

It is recommended that the minimum duration for the student activity is approximately 54 hours, combining preparation and the assessed performance.

The ideal model would be for this time to be a block, with one activity being followed, leading up to the assessed performance. Acceptable alternatives include intensive teaching programmes. The duration of assessed performances in each physical activity should be based on appropriate timings to allow students to demonstrate the requirements of a player/performer or coach in the selected physical activity. For example, the duration of competitive situations will differ for each selected physical activity.

Formal assessment of the physical activity may take place at any point during the course.

Practical performance preparation

Teaching and learning

To help students choose a physical activity, teachers should cover the following key points:

- the role of the player/performer or coach in their chosen physical activity
- how they can develop the skills, techniques and attributes to perform successfully in their chosen physical activity
- the rules and laws of their chosen physical activity.

Resources

Students should have access to a range of resources/equipment to enable them to meet the practical demands of their chosen physical activity. Resources and equipment used should follow governing body guidelines/rules, for example ESAA (English Schools Athletics Association) rules for athletics events.

Practical performance taking

Students must choose and perform one physical activity from the set list in the role of player/performer or coach.

Authenticity and Collaboration

Students and teachers must sign the *Practical performance authentication sheet*, please see *Appendix 1*. This is to ensure that the practical performance is the student's own work.

Feedback

Teacher support is a permitted, and important, part of the preparation for the assessed practical performance. Teachers can help students to understand rules/laws of the activities and the assessment criteria. However, feedback is not permitted in the assessed practical performance, unless it is required for health and safety reasons, for example to reduce the risk of injury. During the assessed practical performance teachers are not allowed to coach their students. Any additional feedback must be recorded on the *Practical performance authentication sheet*, please see *Appendix 1*.

Time control

It is suggested that the minimum duration for each student activity is approximately 54 hours, combining preparation and the assessed performance.

The duration of assessed performances in each activity should be based on an appropriate time to allow students to demonstrate the requirements of a player/performer in the selected physical activity, for example the duration of competitive situations will differ for each selected physical activity.

Formal assessments of activities may take place at any point during the course.

Safety

All activities submitted will need to comply with all the appropriate recommendations related to the safety of students as recognised by the Association for Physical Education in their publication, *Safe Practice in Physical Education & School Sport 2012*.

Practical performance marking, standardisation and moderation

Teachers should mark the practical performances of students in the role of player/performer using the assessment criteria in the *Practical performance assessment criteria*. There are separate assessment criteria for each physical activity. These document is found on the Pearson website. Generic assessment criteria can be found on pages 31–35 of this specification.

Teachers should mark the practical performances of students in the role of coach using the assessment criteria on pages 36–41 of this specification. These assessment criteria can also be found in the *Practical performance assessment criteria*.

Teachers should include any comments on the *Practical performance authentication sheet* in *Appendix 1* to justify the marks awarded.

Where marking has been carried out by more than one teacher in a centre, there must be a process of internal standardisation carried out to ensure that there is a consistent application of the assessment criteria.

Marks awarded by the centre will be subject to external moderation by Pearson. Moderation will ensure consistency with national standards and will include a review of marking to ensure that the rules have been correctly applied by centres. Pearson/moderators, in consultation with the centre, will select a representative sample of students of different abilities, and in a range of activities, and taking cohort size into account. For activities that cannot be assessed live on moderation day, centres must video record the evidence of the assessment. This evidence will be used to support the marks awarded and must be provided if requested by Pearson for moderation purposes.

If the moderation indicates that centre assessment does not reflect national standards, an adjustment will be made to students' final marks to compensate for this.

For further information please refer to the Joint Council for Qualifications (JCQ) document *Instructions for conducting non-examination assessments (new GCE and GCSE specifications)* on the JCQ website: www.jcq.org.uk. The assessment of this qualification must comply with these instructions.

Videoing practical performances on moderation day

Centres must video the students in the sample on moderation day. This is to support an EAR, if requested. Centres that do not record on moderation day cannot request an EAR. Please see *Appendix 5: Recording practical performances*, pages 82–86 for full advice and guidance. Centres must submit to Pearson the video evidence collected on moderation day.

Practical performance generic assessment criteria: player/performer

The following is generic assessment criteria, explaining the standard expected at each level for a player/performer.

The assessment criteria for each specific physical activity can be found on our website in the *Pearson Edexcel Level 3 Advanced GCE in Physical Education Practical performance assessment criteria*. The criteria should be used to mark each student's performance.

Skills/Content

Students will be assessed on the quality of appropriate skills, techniques and decision making processes under pressure, to meet the challenges of conditioned practice and a formal/competitive situation.

Level	Marks	Guidance	Description
	0		No rewardable evidence
1	1–8	(1–4 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level.	Demonstrates a basic level of performance. Skills, techniques and decision making are characterised by little precision, control and fluency, during a formal/competitive situation. • Position-specific skills and techniques performed to a basic level. • Skills and techniques performed to a basic level. • Basic influence on performance and motivation of self and others. • Any tactical changes are ineffectively applied in response to the opposition's actions, with multiple misjudgements. • Attempts to adapt to changes in a competitive situation to dominate opponents but with little success.
		(5–8 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level and may sometimes exceed expectations.	

Level	Marks	Guidance	Description
2	9–16	(9–12 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level.	Demonstrates a competent level of performance. Skills, techniques and decision making are characterised by some precision, control and fluency, during a formal/competitive situation. • Position-specific skills and techniques performed to a competent level. • Skills and techniques performed to a competent level. • Competent influence on performance and motivation of self and others. • Tactical changes are sometimes effectively applied in response to the opposition's actions but with misjudgements. • Attempts to adapt to changes in a competitive situation to dominate opponents with some success.
		(13–16 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level and may sometimes exceed expectations.	

Level	Marks	Guidance	Description
3	17–24	(17–20 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level.	Demonstrates a good level of performance. Skills, techniques and decision making are characterised by good precision, control and fluency, during a formal/competitive situation. • Position-specific skills and techniques performed to a good level. • Skills and techniques performed to a good level. • Good influence on performance and motivation of self and others. • Tactical changes are effective in response to the opposition's actions but with minor misjudgements. • Adapts effectively to changes in a competitive situation to dominate opponents with a good level of success.
		(21–24 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level and may sometimes exceed expectations.	

Level	Marks	Guidance	Description
4	25–32	(25–28 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level.	Demonstrates a very good level of performance. Skills, techniques and decision making are characterised by very good precision, control and fluency, during a formal/competitive situation. • Position-specific skills and techniques performed to a very good level. • Skills and techniques performed to a very good level. • Very good influence on performance and motivation of self and others. • Applies tactical changes effectively in response to the opposition's actions with few, if any, misjudgements. • Adapts effectively to changes in a competitive situation to dominate opponents with a very good level of success.
		(29–32 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level and may sometimes exceed expectations.	

Level	Marks	Guidance	Description
5	33–40	(33–36 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level.	Demonstrates an outstanding level of performance. Skills, techniques and decision making are characterised by outstanding precision, control and fluency, during a formal/competitive situation. • Position-specific skills and techniques performed to an outstanding level. • Skills and techniques performed to an outstanding level. • Outstanding influence on performance and motivation of self and others. • Applies tactical changes highly effectively in response to the opposition's actions without misjudgements. • Adapts highly effectively to changes in a competitive situation to dominate opponents with an outstanding level of success.
		(37–40 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level and may sometimes exceed expectations.	

Where it becomes apparent to the assessor that students are not being given the opportunity to demonstrate their full range of skills during a game situation, assessors may intervene to create an opportunity (for example permitting defenders to switch sides) to allow students to demonstrate their appropriate skills. This is to guarantee that all students have the opportunity to demonstrate their skills and decision making because in a competitive game, for example football, it may be that a defender never gets to touch the ball through no fault of their own but because of how the game has evolved. Therefore, giving the player/performer the opportunity to demonstrate appropriate skills in a formal/competitive situation is necessary so that relevant and legitimate marks may be awarded.

Practical performance assessment criteria: coach

The following is assessment criteria for the coach. It can be applied to the assessment of the coach in all of the physical activities in the set list.

Skills/Content

Students will be assessed on their ability to coach effectively through the planning, organisation and delivery of coaching sessions to an individual, group or team while under observation in conditioned practice and a formal/competitive situation:

- judgement of the authority shown by the coach
- sport/activity specific knowledge (of laws, techniques, safeguarding and regulations)
- strategy/planning/aim
- organisation (logistics, planning, health and safety, risk management)
- motivation/inspiration/empathy with individual, group or team
- performance of coaching in a formal/competitive situation – ability to communicate, adapt, and refine – their coaching style and strategies to meet their aim(s)
- analysis and evaluation – feedback and guidance before, during and after the formal/competitive situation, reflecting potential changes in strategy
- use of appropriate physical characteristics/attributes to benefit their own performance
- demonstrate psychological control (e.g. anxiety, arousal, aggression).

Level	Marks	Guidance	Description
	0		No rewardable evidence.
1	1–8	(1–4 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level.	The coach has demonstrated little authority in the planning, organisation, delivery and evaluation of their coaching when under the demands of a formal/competitive performance with an individual, group or team. • Inappropriate and little organisation, with no clear or relevant aim(s), failing to utilise SMART(ER) principles, with inappropriate coaching not relevant to the skill, abilities and fitness of the individual, group or team. • Unclear and convoluted coaching delivery, reflecting a lack of sport/activity-specific knowledge. • Ineffective adaptations of communication and coaching style, reflecting a lack of empathy in meeting the needs of the individual, group or team through the use of voice, gesture and/or demonstration. • Responding poorly and inappropriately to changing formal/competitive situation and/or external conditions. • The feedback and guidance (based on poor quality interpretation of performance data and/or observation) when given is inaccurate, lacks support for and not targeted to needs of the individual, group or team. • Self-reflection demonstrates limited consideration of the areas for personal improvement as a coach.
		(5–8 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level and may sometimes exceed expectations.	

Level	Marks	Guidance	Description
2	9–16	(9–12 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level.	The coach has demonstrated limited authority in the planning, organisation, delivery and evaluation of their coaching when under the demands of a formal/competitive performance with an individual, group or team. • Some evidence of appropriate and structured organisation, with a defined aim(s), a limited use of SMART(ER) principles, with emerging coaching relevant to the skill, abilities and fitness of an individual, group or team. • The level of coaching delivery, reflects some simplistic sport/activity-specific knowledge. • Adaptations of communication and coaching structure/methods support in part with emerging empathy the needs of the individual, group or team seen through the occasional appropriate use of voice, gesture and/or demonstration, responding with occasional flexibility and corrections to a changing formal/competitive situation and/or external conditions. • Attempts to respond to changing formal/competitive situation and/or external conditions with limited success. • The feedback and guidance is mainly uninformative (based on a simplistic interpretation of performance data and/or observation) and when given only occasionally meets the needs of the individual, group or team. • Self-reflection demonstrates some relevant insight when considering of the areas for personal improvement as a coach.
		(13–16 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level and may sometimes exceed expectations.	

Level	Marks	Guidance	Description
3	17–24	(17–20 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level.	The coach has demonstrated an emerging level of authority in the planning, organisation, delivery and evaluation of their coaching when under the demands of a formal/competitive performance with an individual, group or team. • Invariably appropriate and structured organisation, with a defined aim(s), based in part on the full use of SMART(ER) principles, with observations of appropriate coaching relevant to the skill, abilities and fitness of the individual, group or team. • Reliable quality coaching delivery, reflecting a developing sport/activity-specific knowledge. • Increasing and more effective adaptations of communication and coaching style, showing appropriate empathy to meet the needs of the individual, group or team seen through the developing use of voice, gesture and/or demonstration. • Responses show signs of flexibility to the changing formal/competitive situation and/or external conditions. • The feedback and guidance (based on some accurate interpretation of performance data and/or observation) when given can be relevant and targeted to needs of the individual, group or team. • Self-reflection demonstrates a more secure insight into the areas for personal improvement as a coach.
		(21–24 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level and may sometimes exceed expectations.	

Level	Marks	Guidance	Description
4	25–32	(25–28 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level.	The coach has demonstrated a secure level of authority in the planning, organisation, delivery and evaluation of their coaching when under the demands of a formal/competitive performance with an individual, group or team. • Appropriate and structured organisation, with a defined aim(s), effectively using SMART(ER) principles, with appropriate coaching relevant to the skill, abilities and fitness of the individual, group or team, with occasional errors. • Sessions reflect clear, concise, and increasingly effective coaching delivery, reflecting a more detailed range of sport/activity-specific knowledge and an invariable ability to manage the coaching environment. • Evidence of effective adaptations of communication and coaching style, showing appropriate empathy to meet the needs of the individual, group or team, with few, if any, errors in the use of voice, gesture, and/or demonstration. • Responses to changing formal/competitive situation and/or external conditions are flexible and correct with only minor misjudgements. • The feedback and guidance (based on accurate interpretation of performance data and/or observation) given is accurate, relevant and targeted to needs of the individual, group or team, with only few minor misjudgements, and the use of coaching aids, e.g. video, may be employed. • Self-reflection demonstrates informative considerations of the areas for personal improvement as a coach.
		(29–32 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level and may sometimes exceed expectations.	

Level	Marks	Guidance	Description
5	33–40	(33–36 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level.	The coach has demonstrated an assured level authority in the planning, organisation, delivery and evaluation of their coaching when under the demands of a formal/competitive performance with an individual, group or team. • Appropriate and structured organisation, with a clearly defined aim(s), fully utilising SMART(ER) principles, with appropriate coaching relevant to the skill, abilities and fitness of the individual, group or team. • Clear, concise, and effective coaching delivery, reflecting a thorough sport/activity-specific knowledge and a mature ability to manage the coaching environment. • Effective and enhancing adaptations of communication and coaching style, showing appropriate empathy to meet the needs of the individual, group or team seen through the effective use of voice, gesture and/or demonstration. • Responding flexibly and correctly to changing formal/competitive situation and/or external conditions. • The feedback and guidance (based on accurate interpretation of performance data and/or observation) given is insightful, relevant and targeted to needs of the individual, group or team, and the use of coaching aids, e.g. video, may be employed. • Self-reflection demonstrates critical and insightful considerations of the areas for personal improvement as a coach.
		(37–40 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level and may sometimes exceed expectations.	

Component 4: Performance Analysis and Performance Development Programme

In Component 4 students must complete a Performance Analysis and then, based on the results of the analysis, produce a Performance Development Programme (PDP). Full details are outlined on the following pages.

Performance Analysis

Overview

In the Performance Analysis, in either the role of player/performer or coach, students will investigate two components of a physical activity (one physiological component **and either** a technical **or** a tactical component) in order to analyse and evaluate the effectiveness of their own performance. Students will demonstrate knowledge and understanding of performance analysis in order to produce an evaluation to demonstrate strengths and weaknesses and areas for development of a performance.

Content

- The Performance Analysis is designed to engage the student in an independent study of their chosen physical activity.
- Students must choose the same physical activity for both the physiological component **and either** the technical **or** tactical component.
- It is recommended that students carry out their Performance Analysis and PDP in the same role and physical activity as undertaken for Component 3: Practical performance.
- Students are required to analyse quantitative and qualitative data to support their conclusions.
- It is recommended that students choose a tactical or technical skill from the list in *Appendix 4*. The list is offered a guide for students but they are permitted to choose a skill from outside the list.

The following table outlines what is required from students in the role of player/performer or coach for the physiological, technical and tactical components of a physical activity.

Physiological component (compulsory)	
Player/performer	Coach
The student will: - consider all the components of fitness required for their performance in their chosen physical activity in order to justify the three most important components of fitness - select a fitness test for each of the three identified components of fitness and analyse the validity and reliability of the selected fitness tests - perform the selected fitness tests and use the quantitative data generated in the tests to identify the strengths and areas for development of each of the three components of fitness - analyse the fitness test results and explain the priorities for training in the future in order to enhance performance.	The student will: - consider all the components of fitness required for either an individual or group in their chosen physical activity in order to justify the three most important components of fitness - select a fitness test for each of the three identified components of fitness and analyse the validity and reliability of the selected fitness tests - supervise the selected fitness tests on either an individual or group. Use the quantitative data generated in the tests to identify the strengths and areas for development of each of the three components of fitness - analyse the fitness test results and explain and justify the priorities for training in the future in order to enhance performance.

Technical component	
Player/performer	Coach
The student will: - using qualitative data, analyse the three phases (preparation, execution, recovery) and the result in one identified core skill for both themselves and by comparison with a higher-level performer - identify strengths and weaknesses and justify the key area(s) for development on the basis of the analysis undertaken.	The student will: - using qualitative data, analyse one core element of coaching for both themselves and by comparison with a higher-level coach. The core elements of coaching are: - types of practice - communication (verbal/non-verbal) - coaching styles - guidance and feedback - planning and organisation - identify strengths and weaknesses and justify the key area(s) for development on the basis of the analysis undertaken.

Tactical component	
Player/performer	Coach
The student will: • using qualitative and/or quantitative data analyse one tactic and its application • analyse how and why the tactic can be adapted to changing circumstances in a competitive or formal performance.	The student will: • using qualitative and/or quantitative data analyse one tactic and its application • analyse how and why the tactic can be adapted to changing circumstances in a competitive or formal performance.

Definitions of key terms

The following definitions explain the meanings of the key terms which are used in the Performance Analysis:

- **physical activity** refers to any of the Department for Education's approved sports or physical activities
- a **player/performer** will participate in a physical activity approved by the Department for Education
- a **coach** is responsible for leading an individual, group or team in one physical activity with the aim of optimising the coach's performance. The focus of this work is on the role of the coach and the quality of knowledge and understanding to coach; **not** the improvement of those being coached
- **components of a physical activity**
 - **physiological components** are those aspects of performance linked to the body's response to exercise and adaptations to training
 - **technical components** are the specific sequence of sub-routines to be mastered to achieve success in the performance of the identified skill
 - **tactical components** are plans devised and implemented in order to gain an advantage in a competitive or formal situation
- **skills** are organised movement patterns requiring body control, rhythm and timing, motor production and co-ordination
- a **peer** is someone of the same age (within +/- one school year to take account of biological maturity) in the activity identified.

Performance Development Programme

Overview

The Performance Development Programme (PDP) is designed to lead on from the student's Performance Analysis. The purpose of the PDP is to optimise the student's performance in the role of a player/performer or coach.

Player/performer

As a player/performer, students will identify one of the two components of a physical activity they worked on in their Performance Analysis (physiological, technical or tactical). They will then plan, perform and record their performance in this component of the physical activity over 8–10 weeks. They will apply appropriate principles and methods of training and SMART(ER) targets to a plan designed to optimise performance. They will then critically evaluate the outcomes of their programme against its original aims.

Coach

As a coach, students will identify one of the two components of a physical activity they worked on in their Performance Analysis (physiological, technical or tactical). They will then plan, perform and record their coaching performance in this component of the physical activity, with the involvement of the individual or group they are coaching, over 8–10 weeks. Through the delivery of a coaching programme the student will demonstrate enhanced knowledge and application of coaching principles and theory. They will then critically evaluate the outcomes of their programme against its original aims.

Content

Planning	
Player/performer	Coach
The student will select one component of performance, (physiological, technical or tactical), and based on the outcomes of the Performance Analysis, outline an appropriate training programme that includes: • SMART(ER) targets • principles and methods of training • the selection of appropriate test(s) to monitor progress.	The student will select one component of coaching, (physiological, technical or tactical) and based on the outcomes of the Performance Analysis, outline an appropriate coaching programme for their individual/group/team that includes: • SMART(ER) targets • application of the principles and methods of coaching • the selection of appropriate methods to monitor their own coaching progress.

Performing and recording	
Player/performer	Coach
The student will undertake the training programme as planned and document a record of every training session undertaken throughout the development. The student may gather as much evidence as appropriate to the needs of the review and evaluation. A template is provided but evidence may also be recorded in other formats.	The student will lead their individual/group/team through a coaching programme as planned and document a record of every training session undertaken throughout the development. The student may gather as much evidence as appropriate to the needs of the review and evaluation. A template is provided but evidence may also be recorded in other formats.

Review and evaluation	
Player/performer	Coach
The student will produce a critical evaluation of their personal development based on: - an evaluation of the effectiveness of the training programme based on evidence gathered and supported by qualitative and quantitative data - suggestions for future development.	The student will produce a critical evaluation of their personal development as a coach based on: - an evaluation of the effectiveness of the coaching programme based on evidence gathered and supported by qualitative and quantitative data - suggestions for future development.

Definitions of key terms

The following definitions explain the meanings of the key terms which are used in the Performance Development Programme:

- physical activity** refers to any of the Department for Education's approved sports or physical activities
- a **player/performer** will participate in a physical activity approved by the Department for Education
- a **coach** is responsible for leading an individual, group or team in one physical activity with the aim of optimising the coach's performance. The focus of this work is on the role of the coach and the quality of knowledge and understanding to coach; **not** the improvement of those being coached
- Components of a physical activity**
 - physiological components** are those aspects of performance linked to the body's response to exercise and adaptations to training
 - technical components** are the specific sequence of sub-routines to be mastered to achieve success in the performance of the identified skill
 - tactical components** are plans devised and implemented in order to gain an advantage in a competitive or formal situation
- skills** are organised movement patterns requiring body control, rhythm and timing, motor production and co-ordination
- a **peer** is someone of the same age (within +/- one school year to take account of biological maturity) in the activity identified
- the **programme** is concerned with identifying the training necessary to achieve aims and objectives linked to further improving performance

- the **recording** will be a written account to provide evidence of the training undertake
- the **review and evaluation** requires the student to critically assess the extent to which the stated aims have been achieved.